

Summary: Key & Exciting Events

Concise version based on the letter dated April 18, 1890

Changed Travel Plans to America

The original ship, "City of New York," was damaged and taken out of service. The travel group then decided to rebook onto the Cunard Line's state-of-the-art and much larger vessel, the S/S Aurania (8,000 tons).

Rough Crossing in Steerage

The group chose to travel in third class to accustom themselves to hardships. They shared a cramped, low-ceilinged space on the steerage deck with over 200 other passengers, where the living conditions are described as highly deficient and untidy.

Immunity to Seasickness

During a severe storm on the North Sea, almost all passengers below deck suffered from extreme seasickness. However, neither the author nor his companion Arvid felt any symptoms, maintaining a full appetite for their packed provisions throughout the journey.

Impressions of the English Countryside

Following the customs inspection in Hull, the journey continued by special train to Liverpool. Before dark, the author was struck by how remarkably clean, uniform, and well-maintained the English agricultural landscape was with its hawthorn hedges, contrasting sharply with the wooden fences back in Sweden.

Encounter with Liverpool's "Elephant Horses"

Upon arriving in Liverpool, the author was fascinated by the city's grand scale and the gigantic draft horses, which he compared to elephants. He also noted the extremely heavily built work wagons and the unique mechanical balancing of the cabs.